

Flock 2.5 targets Twitter and Facebook Users

The Flock development team has released a newer version of the social Web browser. Flock 2.5 [www.flock.com] makes both sharing and discovering content fast and easy. To share content, you simply drag and drop URLs, photos, videos, text or other content you find on the Web to a friend's Twitter, Facebook, MySpace or other profile in Flock's People Sidebar, and it is instantly shared. Flock now also



comes with Twitter Search that allows you to save all of your Twitter searches and keep them in one place, making the discovery of content automatic and straightforward.

The new FlockCast capability allows you to 'broadcast' your public actions to multiple locations at once, eliminating duplicate effort. Flock makes posting and promoting your

own blogs into Facebook effortless; drag and drop content you find anywhere on the Web into your favourite blog and Flock posts it to your Facebook newsfeed. You can also automatically post your Tweets, status updates from MySpace, Bebo and other networks, along with blog posts and photo uploads to Facebook. And when you share a URL in a Twitter message, Flock automatically shortens the URL—eliminating the need to shorten the URL with yet another site.

Flock 2.5 also includes Facebook Chat for instant messaging with friends. Facebook Chat lets you see when other people are on online and makes sharing your discoveries with them easy, so you can remain connected while you travel across the Web. You can also drag and drop photos, videos, links and text into your chats, making your Web experience simple, social and fun. Videos of the new Flock 2.5 can be found at www.flock.com/tour/new.php.

Develop widgets with Maemo 5 Beta SDK

Nokia has released the Maemo 5 Beta SDK that will, among other things, also enable the development of widgets for the Maemo 5 Desktop. Maemo 5 is the next major release of the Linux platform developed by Nokia in collaboration with some of the best open source community projects. The key new features are: OMAP3 support, HSPA data connectivity, high-definition camera support, hardware-based graphics acceleration, etc. The SDK still includes a simplified UI implementation of the desktop and the application Menu. The Desktop Edit Mode is now enabled in order to ease the development and testing of desktop widgets.

This release comes with the first draft of the Development Manual. Also, a new example application and desktop widget are provided to help developers getting familiar with the new UI style driven by finger touch interfaces. The developer documentation, including new code examples, will be updated regularly, independent of new SDK releases. Point your browser to maemo.org/development/sdks to grab the latest release.



GStreamer plug-in for OMAP35x processors

Minimising the complexity of software integration with a uniform open source multimedia framework, Texas Instruments (TI) has announced a new GStreamer plug-in for developers designing with OMAP35x processors and digital media processors based on DaVinci technology. Praveen K Ganapathy, director, business development, Texas Instruments India said, "The plug-in helps optimise systems to utilise the hardware accelerators or the digital signal processor (DSP) for processing-intensive tasks, such as video and audio decoding/encoding. This frees the ARM to handle other tasks so developers can deliver a feature-rich multimedia experience with improved Web browsing and video streaming through products such as media players, video editors and capture encoders." The TI GStreamer plug-in can be downloaded at www.ti.com/gstreamer-pr.

MontaVista introduces MontaVista Linux 6

MontaVista Software has released MontaVista Linux 6. The new version provides a complete embedded Linux development environment comprising Market Specific Distributions, development tools, and the support and maintenance required by developers to fully leverage the semiconductor Linux technology and resources from the open source community. This approach to embedded Linux is fully aligned with the embedded Linux supply chain for the first time. MontaVista Linux 6 is in use by beta customers currently and will be generally available in July 2009.